

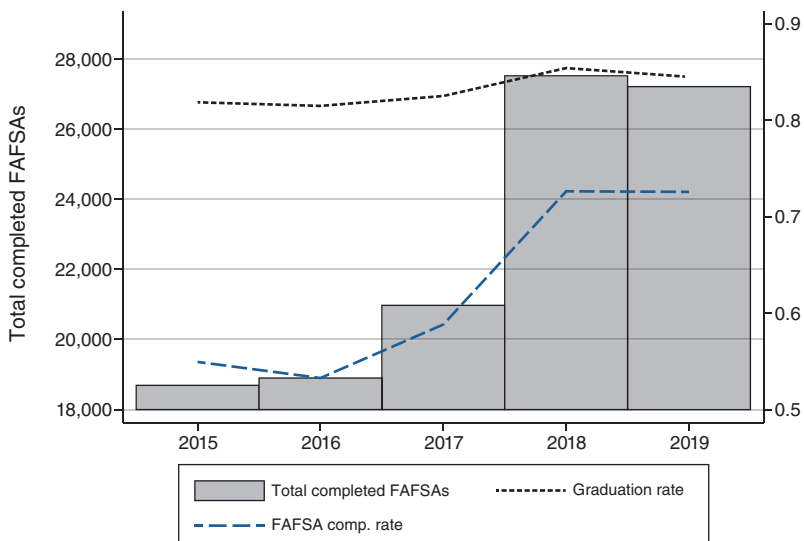


FIGURE 3. TOTAL FAFSAs COMPLETED, FAFSA COMPLETION RATE, AND HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATION RATES

Notes: Total completions are total FAFSA completions as of June of the students' graduating year for the schools in my sample. Completion rate and graduation rate are the weighted average of these schools.

Sources: Office of Student Financial Aid and LDOE

How the mandate affected FAFSA completions—the first stage—is visualized in Figures 1 and 2 and formally estimated via equation (3), with results reported in Table 2.²⁶ Columns 1 and 2 present estimates of the policy's effect on FAFSA completion rates from specifications without and with controls, respectively. I find that a school in the pretreatment period with a 0 percent completion rate would have a 41 percentage point increase in completion rate as a result of this policy relative to schools that had a 100 percent completion rate in the pretreatment period.²⁷

B. *Estimated Reduced-Form Effect of the Mandate on College Enrollment*

As hypothesized, the estimates in Table 2 demonstrate that schools that were more affected by this policy, ones with low FAFSA completion rates in the pretreatment period, had a larger increase in the percentage of students enrolled in college in the fall, as indicated in columns 3 and 4. These estimates represent the reduced-form estimates of β as calculated from equation (1) without and with controls, respectively. My preferred specification includes controls (column 4), which indicates that the policy increased students enrolled in college in the fall for a school with zero FAFSA completions in the pretreatment period relative to a school with a

²⁶ Online Appendix Figure A4 shows the raw percent change in college enrollment over the percent change in FAFSA completion rates by treatment intensity.

²⁷ The calculation of the differential percent increase in completion rate changes postmandate between two schools is explained in the online Appendix.